

Safe hands

'Safe hands' is a way to teach your children how to manage their feelings without becoming physical or violent.

If your child is prone to lashing out by hitting, kicking or biting, you can teach them to stop when you say 'safe hands and body'. This is the signal to them to immediately stop being physical.

When you say 'safe hands' your child can put their hands together and interlace their fingers, which is symbolic of them remembering to keep their hands to themselves and avoid hurting others/ becoming physical.

So, how can you start to teach the safe hands technique?

Encourage them to try it out with you when they are calm. Explain to them that hurting others isn't ok, and that you will remind them of this by saying 'safe hands'. On hearing this, they must place their hands together and lace their fingers. They can also put their feet together or cross their legs as a reminder not to kick others. You can ask them to put their finger on their lips to help prevent them biting or swearing too.

Keep practising this during calm times, and when your child becomes emotionally dysregulated you can use 'safe hands' as a prompt to remind them. Once they have done this and stopped the aggressive behaviour, help them to regulate using ways to calm down that work for your child. Once they are calm you can address any problems with them and help them to find a solution.

Overleaf is a poster which you may wish to display as a reminder of safe hands and body.

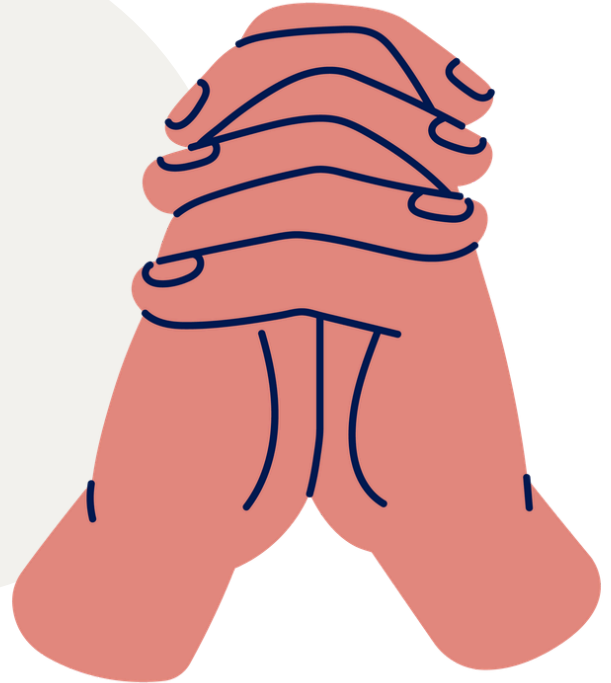


Scan here to watch how one mum uses this technique with their child.



I can have...

Safe hands



Safe feet



Safe body

